

Instructions for using the iDeer Tool

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1.0	1.0	05/12/2025	-

The iDeer Tool displays 6 tabs along the top of the screen. Clicking on these tabs will take you to one of the following pages: **Welcome**, **Instructions**, **Select your area**, **Deer species present**, **Plant new woodlands**, **Predicted impact risk maps after planting** and **About iDeer**. Below we briefly describe what you will find in each page and how to navigate and use the iDeer Tool to produce Deer Impact Risk maps and explore options for woodland planting.

Tab 1: Welcome

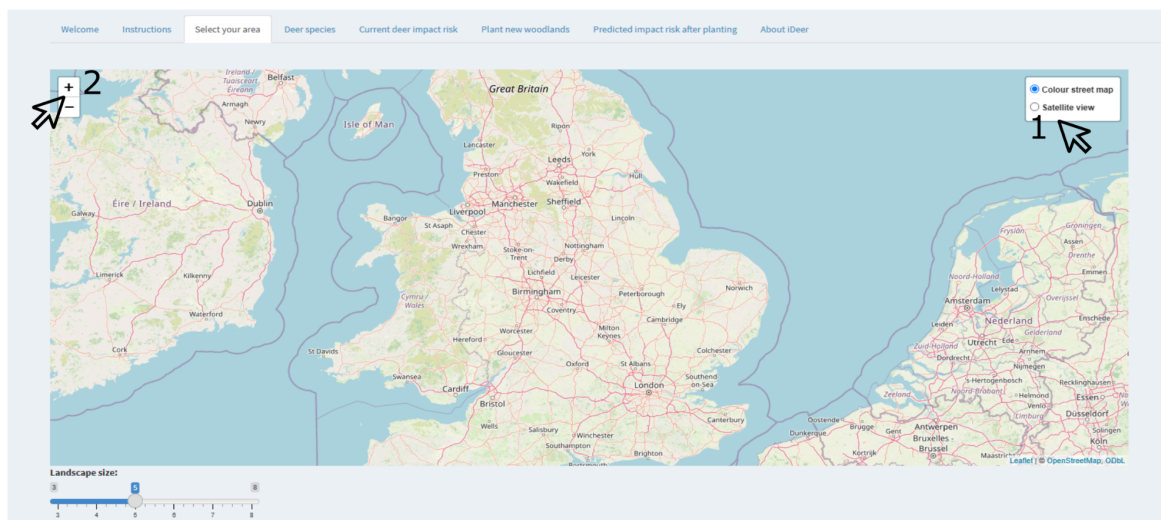
On opening the tool you will be greeted with the **Welcome** tab, which gives background information behind the iDeer Tool and explains its purpose. It also contains a link to an anonymous feedback form designed to collect information from users so we can improve the iDeer Tool.

Tab 2: Instructions

The **Instructions** tab provides guidance on how to use the iDeer Tool. Here we provide a step-by-step guide on how to navigate the tool, create and download deer impact risk maps before and after woodland planting.

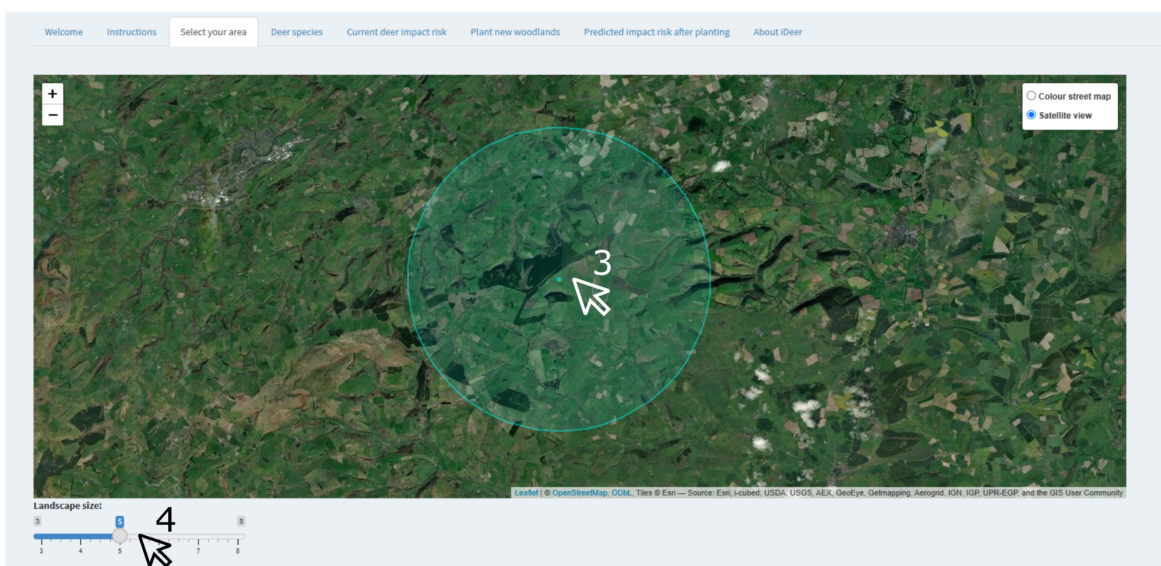
Tab 3: Select your area

The **Select your area** tab presents an interactive map centred on England and Wales. You can switch between a Colour Street Map or Satellite View using the buttons in the top right of the tab **(1)**. You can also zoom in and out by clicking the +/- buttons in the top left of the tab, or scrolling using your mouse wheel or laptop trackpad **(2)**.



You can select the area for which you would like to produce Deer Impact Risk Maps by clicking anywhere on the map within England or Wales **(3)**. After you click on the map, a loading icon will flash up briefly, then a blue circle will appear around the clicked point. If the clicked point is not in the right place, just click on the correct point and the circle will appear around the new clicked position.

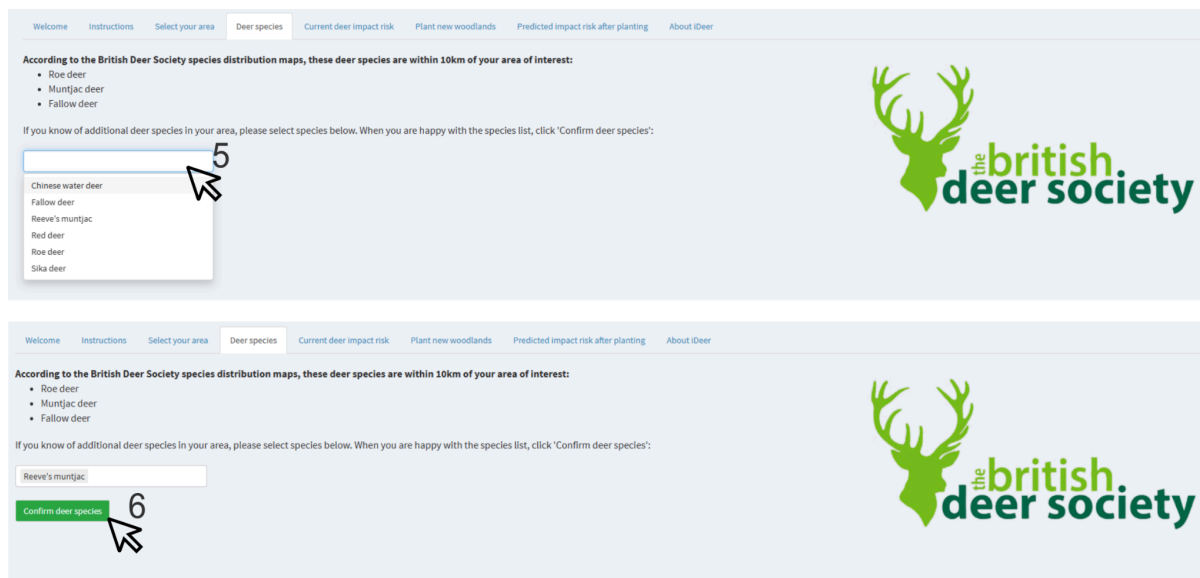
You can also change the radius of this circle using the sliding bar in the bottom left of the tab, from 3 km up to 8km **(4)**. The size of this circle determines the size of the deer impact risk map(s) that will be generated by the iDeer Tool.



Tab 4: Deer species

The **Deer Species** tab uses species distribution maps from the British Deer Society to identify which deer species are present within 10km of the area you have selected. However, if you have seen additional deer species in your area that are not included on the list. You

can add them to the list using the drop-down box **(5)**. If you select a species accidentally, use the Delete button on your keyboard to remove them. When you are happy with the deer species list, click "Confirm deer species" **(6)**, then move on to the next tab.



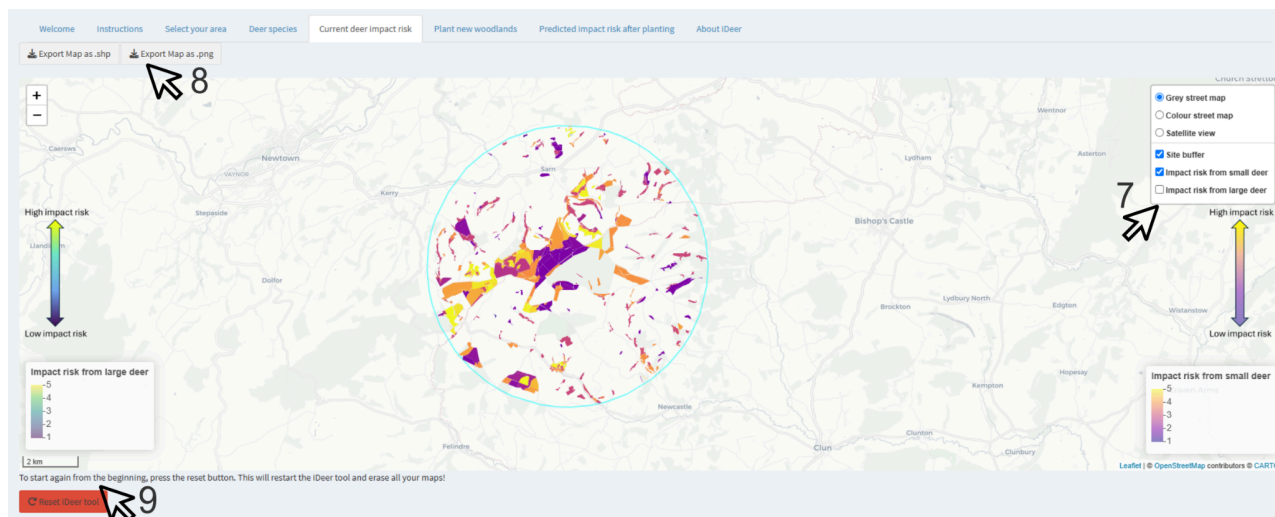
Tab 5: Current deer impact risk

The **Current deer impact risk** tab displays the Deer Impact Risk map for your selected area. The maps displayed in this tab will depend on the deer species in the landscape in the previous tab. If the deer species list contained any of the small deer species (roe deer, Chinese water deer or Reeve's muntjac), you will see a Deer Impact Risk map for the small deer. If the deer species list contained any of the large deer species (red deer, sika deer or fallow deer), you will see a Deer Impact Risk map for the large deer. If both maps are displayed, you can switch between them by selecting the relevant map using the tick-box menu on the top right corner **(7)**.

The Deer Impact Risk score in each map can range from 1 (low Deer Impact Risk) to 5 (high Deer Impact Risk). There is a separate colour scale for the map displaying the Deer Impact Risk posed by small deer and the map displaying the Deer Impact Risk posed by large deer. You can download the map(s) as a Shapefile ending in .shp (which can be used in GIS mapping software) or a Portable Network Graphic (.png) image (which can be pasted directly into word processing software or email, or be printed out) by clicking the buttons above the maps **(8)**. The files may take a few seconds to save and should appear in your computer downloads folder in zip files.

If you download the map(s) as a Shapefile, the column "mean_risk" is the impact risk score for each woodland, "wood_ID" is the ID number for each woodland, and "Area_Ha" is the area of each woodland in hectares.

If you want to reset the iDeer tool and start from scratch, click the **"Reset iDeer tool" button (9)**. **This will erase all your progress so far**, so only click this if you're sure you want to reset the iDeer Tool completely!



If there are no woodlands present in the landscape you have selected, a message will appear informing you of this. Don't worry, you can still test different woodland planting scenarios in the next tab **Plant new woodlands**.

Tab 6: Plant new woodlands

In the **Plant new woodlands** tab, you can see how predicted Deer Impact Risk to existing woodland changes if you plant new woodland, and the predicted Deer Impact Risk to the new woodland.

Using the tool panel to the left (10), you can draw new woodlands on your map. For example, if you click on the **“Draw a polygon”** button, you can draw a woodland by clicking on sequential points on the map and joining them up to make a shape. If you make a mistake while drawing a shape, you can delete the last point by clicking **“Delete last point”**. To save your shape, click **“Finish”**. To cancel the drawing, click **“Cancel”**.



The **“Draw a rectangle”** button allows you to draw a regular square or rectangle. Click **“Cancel”** to cancel the drawing.



After you have drawn woodlands on the map, you can edit the shapes by clicking on the **“Edit layers”** button which allows you to click and drag the points to change the shape of the woodland, or you can click and drag the whole shape to a different location. To cancel any change, click **“Cancel”**. To save your changes, click **“Save”**.

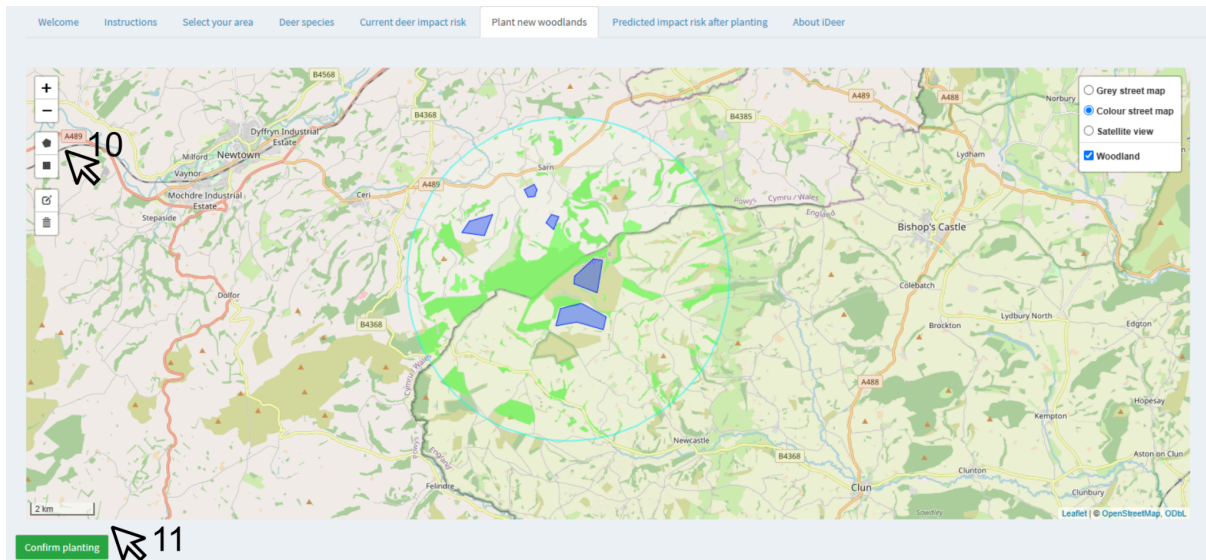


To delete a woodland, click on the **“Delete layers”** button then click on the woodland you want to delete. To undo any deletions, click **“Cancel”**. To clear the map and start again, click **“Clear All”**.

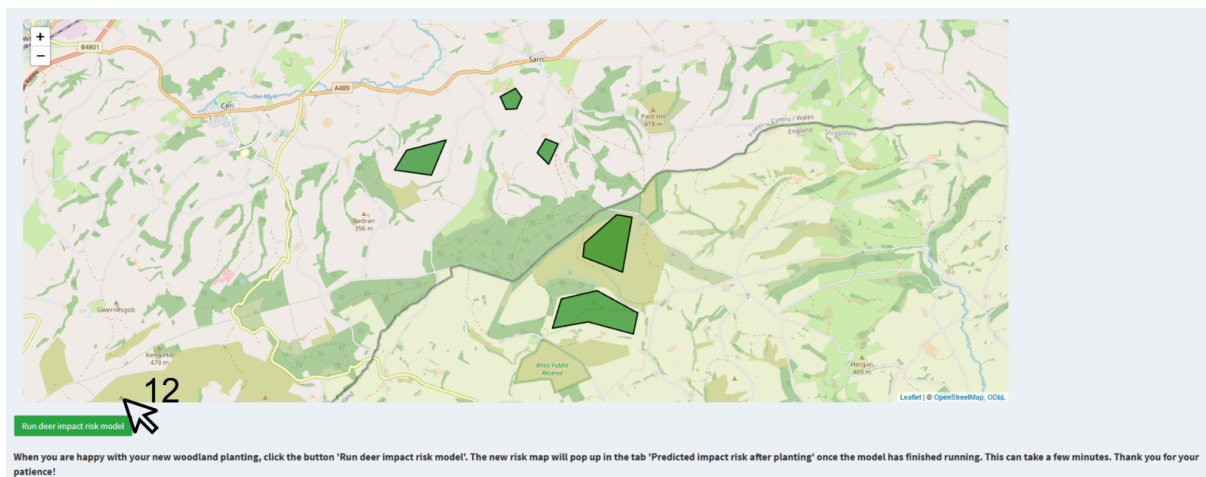


Only draw woodlands inside the blue circle, or you will be asked to start your drawing again. Also, when drawing a woodland, ensure the edges do not overlap each other, or an error message will appear, and you will need to start again.

When you click "Confirm woodland planting" **(11)** your new woodlands will appear under the map already displayed. You will need to scroll down to view it. You can return to the map at the top of the screen and redraw your woodland until you are happy with them.



When you have finished drawing and confirmed the woodland planting, click "Run deer risk model" **(12)** and the iDeer Tool will begin updating the Deer Impact Risk map for your landscape.



The loading graphic will appear again and flash until the models have finished running, at which point you will see a message telling you the maps are ready, and to view them in the text tab.

Your woodland planting is complete!

Please click on the 'Predicted impact risk after planting' tab to view your updated impact risk maps.

Tab 7: Predicted impact risk after planting

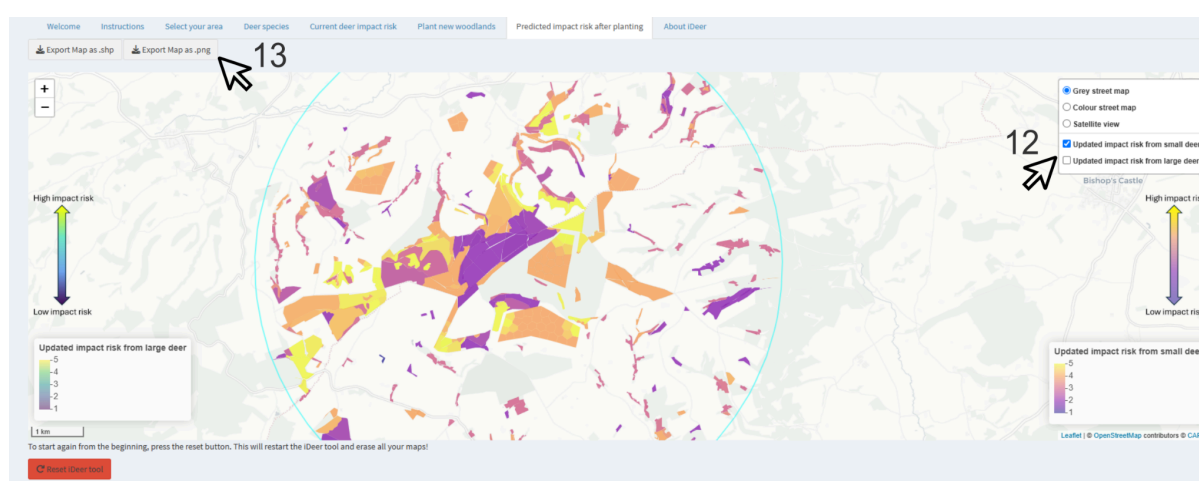
The maps displayed in the **Predicted impact risk after planting** tab will look similar to the maps produced in the **Current deer impact risk** tab. However, the Deer Impact Risk scores for existing woodlands may be adjusted if new woodland planting has resulted in changes to Deer Impact Risk in the landscape. In addition, your newly drawn woodlands will appear on the map with their newly calculated Deer Impact Risk scores. By carefully comparing the maps before and after planting, this information could aid your decision making on where to plant new woodlands, and what management measures need to be put in place to manage Deer Impact Risk after planting to increase success of sapling establishment and growth.

You can switch between the updated risk maps for small species Deer Impact Risk and large species Deer Impact Risk using the tick-box menu on the right (12).

The new woodlands have been split into polygons with a minimum area of 2.5 hectares. This will allow you to see any differences in impact risk across your new woodlands, especially if they are particularly large.

As before, you can download the maps as a Shapefile ending in .shp or a Portable Network Graphic (.png) image by clicking the buttons above the maps (13). The files may take a few seconds to save and should appear in your computer downloads folder in zip files.

If you download the map(s) as a Shapefile, the column “mean_risk” is the mean impact risk score for each woodland, “wood_ID” is a unique ID number for each woodland in your map, and “Area_Ha” is the area of each woodland in hectares.





Tab 8: About iDeer

The final tab **About iDeer** gives information about when Project iDeer ran, funding and a list of the Project iDeer team.